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Functional Skills Level 1 English Writing Sample Paper 3

Worked Example – good pass

Candidate Name: Master Functional Skills | **Enrolment No: MFS4748**

Centre Name: Master Functional Skills | Centre Number: MFS0001

Candidate Signature: Master Functional Skills | Assessment Date: 20/10/2026

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Worked Example - Sample Paper 3 Level 1 – Good Pass

Question 1

Your task: choose **one** of the following topics and write a set of instructions for someone who is brand new to the topic.

- How to load and play a video game.
- How to play a boardgame, for example, Monopoly, Chess, Draughts or Snakes and Ladders.
- How to bake a cake or make a meal.
- How to follow evacuation procedures where you study or work.
- How to learn to ride a bike.
- How to do a trick on a skateboard.
- How to play a game, for example, football or netball.
- How to use social media.
- How to build a snowman.
- How to drive a car.

(27 marks)

Suggested word count 200 – 250 words.

Worked Example - Sample Paper 3 Level 1 – Good Pass

How to learn to ride a bike

Riding a bike is a skill that never leaves a person. For those who can do it, it looks easy. but is it really that easy. Read on to find out how to learn to ride a bike.

1 Firstly find a safe place to learn. Do not do it on a road. An empty car park is a good place, but even better is a grassed area like a park. When you fall off and you will you will not hurt yourself.

2 Secoundly always where safty protection gear. A helmet, lights, gloves and elbow pads are recomended aswell

3 Make sure the bike is in a good condition and that the saddle is at the right height for you.

4 have someone with you to help.

5 Sit on the bike and keep both hands on the handle bar and both feet on the ground

6 using either foot move one of the pedals in a backwards circle so it is very close to the top of it’s rotation.

7 Place your foot on the high pedal and with your other foot on the ground push the bike forward and push down on the high pedal at the same time.

8 If someone is with you they can hold the back of the saddle and give you a little push to get you going.

9 then put the foot that was on the ground onto the other pedal and continue to turn the pedals with your feet and try to keep your balanse and move in a straight line.

Worked Example - Sample Paper 3 Level 1 – Good Pass

10 The person with you can continue to keep hold of the saddal to help you keep your balance.

11 practice and don't give up!

Question 1	**Band 4**	**Band 3**	**Band 2**	**Band 1**	
	Consistently	**Most of the time**	**Some of the time**	**Limited**	
Communicates information, ideas and opinions clearly, coherently and accurately	✓				
Writes text of appropriate detail and length	✓				
Uses appropriate format, structure and paragraphing	✓				
Writes with accurate complex sentences and uses appropriate language	✓				
Overall band	Band 4				
Composition Marks	(12-15)	(8-11)	(4-7)	(0-3)	15

Question 1	**Consistently accurate at appropriate level 4 marks**	**Accurate most of the time 3 marks**	**Accurate some of the time 2 marks**	**Limited accuracy 1 mark**	**Insufficient evidence 0 marks**	
Spelling		3				
Punctuation			2			
Grammar	4					
SPaG Total						9
SPaG mark + composition mark						24

Composition

This response is very effective in communicating its message. Format and structure are excellent, with good use of a title, introduction and numbered points, all of which add to the excellent coherence of the piece as a whole. Length and detail are appropriate and the language and use of varied sentence structures, including accurately constructed complex sentences, demonstrate effective command and control of the subject matter and text type.

Worked Example - Sample Paper 3 Level 1 – Good Pass

Spelling, punctuation and grammar

Most words are spelt correctly and are appropriate to the audience and purpose of the text. Spelling errors include *secondly, safety, recommend, as well, saddle* and *balance*.

Punctuation errors are numerous and include missing commas and question marks, an apostrophe where none is required, an inconsistency in starting numbered points with a capital letter, an omitted full stop and one instance of a sentence not starting with a capital letter. Commas have been used to separate items in a list and, on one occasion, to separate clauses.

Grammar is correct throughout.

Worked Example - Sample Paper 3 Level 1 – Good Pass

Question 2

At work, you noticed several health and safety hazards and decide to write an email to your manager. The hazards included:

- a missing fire extinguisher
- a fire door propped open
- a blocked fire exit
- people smoking where they are not allowed to smoke.

Your task: write an email to your manager, explaining the following:

- why you are writing
- what you have seen
- the location of each hazard
- what the possible dangers are
- how each hazard should be corrected.

The person to send your email to is James Freeman, and his email address is jfreeman@bth.co.uk

Suggested word count 200 – 250 words.

(27 marks)

Worked Example - Sample Paper 3 Level 1 – Good Pass

To: jfreeman@bth.co.uk
CC:
Subject:
Hello james Someone has taken the fire extinguisher off the wall just by the lifts, if there was a fire there it would be impossible to put out. The extinguisher should be put back as soon as posible. I think it is being used to keep a door open by the stairs. As far as I know, that door should be closed at all times because it is a fire door. I also noticed that someone had put three boxes of paper infront of the fire excape, which would cause all sorts of problems getting out if there was a fire. The paper itself might catch on fire and then it couldn't be moved out of the way. I wanted to move them, but they were a bit heavy for me. The last thing I noticed was people smoking just outside the front doors. There is a no smoking sign there but they were ignoring it. I had to walk through the smoke and I am sure I inhaled some of it and my clothe's smell aswell. I think they should be told to move away from the front door and be reminded of the rules.

Worked Example - Sample Paper 3 Level 1 – Good Pass

Question 2	**Band 4**	**Band 3**	**Band 2**	**Band 1**	
	Consistently	**Most of the time**	**Some of the time**	**Limited**	
Communicates information, ideas and opinions clearly, coherently and accurately		✓			
Writes text of appropriate detail and length		✓			
Uses appropriate format, structure and paragraphing			✓		
Writes with accurate complex sentences and uses appropriate language		✓			
Overall band	Band 3				
Composition Marks	(12-15)	(8-11)	(4-7)	(0-3)	10

Question 2	**Consistently accurate at appropriate level 4 marks**	**Accurate most of the time 3 marks**	**Accurate some of the time 2 marks**	**Limited accuracy 1 mark**	**Insufficient evidence 0 marks**	
Spelling		3				
Punctuation			2			
Grammar	4					
SPaG Total						9
SPaG mark + composition mark						19

Overall mark for question 1	24
Overall mark for question 2	19
FINAL MARK	43

Composition

Overall composition falls into band 3. The overall clarity of the message could be better served if the subject line was completed, the purpose of the email was given at the beginning and the points were listed or, at the very least separated by paragraphs breaks.

The omission of a subject line and the sender's name mean that some significant details are missing. Both of these omissions also impact upon the format and structure banding.

Language is appropriate to the audience and purpose. There is evidence of correct construction of complex sentences, but it is hard to have absolute confidence that the candidate has full control of their construction due to the presence of comma splices.

Worked Example - Sample Paper 3 Level 1 – Good Pass

Spelling, punctuation and grammar

Most words are spelt correctly; however, there are five errors: *safety; possible; in front; escape; as well.*

There is some evidence of using commas to separate clauses, but they are not used in all instances where they are required. In addition, there are at least two comma splices and one instance of a lower case first person personal pronoun. There is also an omitted capital letter on the recipient's name and one instance of an incorrect apostrophe.

Grammar is correct throughout.

Worked example – Sample paper 3 Level 1 - Pass

Question 1

Your task: choose **one** of the following topics and write a set of instructions for someone who is brand new to the topic.

- How to load and play a video game.
- How to play a boardgame, for example, Monopoly, Chess, Draughts or Snakes and Ladders.
- How to bake a cake or make a meal.
- How to follow evacuation procedures where you study or work.
- How to learn to ride a bike.
- How to do a trick on a skateboard.
- How to play a game, for example, football or netball.
- How to use social media.
- How to build a snowman.
- How to drive a car.

(27 marks)

Suggested word count 200 – 250 words.

How to play football

Football is a game played betwean two teams usualy of 11 player but any number can play if you decide to do that way.

The object of the game.

The object of game is to kick a round ball into the oppositions net which is at one end of the filed. the other team will be trying to kick the ball into your teams net which is at the other end of the filed. If the ball is kicked into a net it is called a goal and the team which scores the most goals are the winner.

rule of the game

The ball cannot be moved by using hands or arms, any other paty of the body can be used. Players usally used the feet or the head.

Worked example – Sample paper 3 Level 1 - Pass

The only person who can use there hands os the goalkeeper, this player stands by the goal and there job is to stop the ball going in the net.

To get the ball of the other team you are not aloud to kick them or push them away or hit any part of the other player, you have to intesept the ball or use you feet to take the ball of them
If the ball goes out which menans it goes out of the area that you are plaing in a player takes a throuw in and they can use there hands to through the ball back in the pitch.

How to win.

If you score more goals than the pther tema then you team has won the match. You have to deside how long the match was and when the time will be finished the team which has more goals is the winner.

Question 1	**Band 4**	**Band 3**	**Band 2**	**Band 1**	
	Consistently	**Most of the time**	**Some of the time**	**Limited**	
Communicates information, ideas and opinions clearly, coherently and accurately	✓				
Writes text of appropriate detail and length	✓				
Uses appropriate format, structure and paragraphing	✓				
Writes with accurate complex sentences and uses appropriate language			✓		
Overall band	Band 4				
Composition Marks	(12-15)	(8-11)	(4-7)	(0-3)	12

Worked example – Sample paper 3 Level 1 - Pass

Question 1	**Consistently accurate at appropriate level 4 marks**	**Accurate most of the time 3 marks**	**Accurate some of the time 2 marks**	**Limited accuracy 1 mark**	**Insufficient evidence 0 marks**	
Spelling				1		
Punctuation				1		
Grammar		3				
SPaG Total						5
SPaG mark + composition mark						17

Commentary

Composition

The strengths of this response include the format and structuring of the response, the clear communication of ideas, the detail provided and the overall functionality. A title and subheadings aid the clarity and contribute to the coherence of the piece. Whilst the language choices are generally appropriate, sentence construction lacks control.

Spelling, punctuation and grammar

Some words have been spelt correctly, but there are many errors, including *between, usually, field, part, is, allowed, intercept, your, means, playing, throw, other, team, decide.*

Punctuation is poor. Errors include comma splices, omitted commas, inconsistent full stops in subheadings, omitted full stops, an omitted apostrophe and lower case letters where capitals are required. It is hard to have confidence that the candidate fully understands when a sentence comes to an end and requires a full stop or when two clauses can be joined by a comma.

Grammar is generally correct although there are some errors of inconsistent/incorrect tense use, subject-verb agreement errors and omitted articles or other word types.

Worked example – Sample paper 3 Level 1 - Pass

Question 2

At work, you noticed several health and safety hazards and decide to write an email to your manager. The hazards included:

- a missing fire extinguisher
- a fire door propped open
- a blocked fire exit
- people smoking where they are not allowed to smoke.

Your task: write an email to your manager, explaining the following:

- why you are writing
- what you have seen
- the location of each hazard
- what the possible dangers are
- how each hazard should be corrected.

The person to send your email to is James Freeman, and his email address is jfreeman@bth.co.uk

Suggested word count 200 – 250 words.

(27 marks)

Worked example – Sample paper 3 Level 1 - Pass

To: jfreeman@bth.co.uk
CC:
Subject: Health and safety Issues
Dear mr Freeman Just a quick email to let you no that I have noticed alot of health and saftey problems as I was walking a round the biulding this morning. I have corrected all of these but I think it was impotant that you were made a ware of them. The first one is a fire extingusher was missing by the lift and it was been used to keep the fire door open. This is not exceptable and is dangerous becases the fire door should be closed to stop the fire spreading and the extingusher should be in the right place so peopel know where it is if there is a fire. The next problem I notoiced was that one of the fire escapes was blocked by the photo copying machine. I think some one has moved it get behind it but they have forgot to move it back again. I moved it back but I think peopel need to know that they should not of done it. The last think I noticed was smokers out side off the main door. When there is a notice that clearly says they should not of been smoking there. I did show them the notice and they just said 'every one smokes there and no one has told them not to.' It is not nice for we peopel who do not smoke becasue we have to walk threw their smoke all the time which is not good for our health, I think it would be good if you told them about the rules about smoking. Thankyou for taking the time to read my email Kind regards J Steele

Worked example – Sample paper 3 Level 1 - Pass

Question 2	**Band 4**	**Band 3**	**Band 2**	**Band 1**	
	Consistently	**Most of the time**	**Some of the time**	**Limited**	
Communicates information, ideas and opinions clearly, coherently and accurately	✓				
Writes text of appropriate detail and length	✓				
Uses appropriate format, structure and paragraphing	✓				
Writes with accurate complex sentences and uses appropriate language		✓			
Overall band	Band 4				
Composition Marks	(12-15)	(8-11)	(4-7)	(0-3)	13

Question 2	**Consistently accurate at appropriate level 4 marks**	**Accurate most of the time 3 marks**	**Accurate some of the time 2 marks**	**Limited accuracy 1 mark**	**Insufficient evidence 0 marks**	
Spelling				1		
Punctuation				1		
Grammar			2			
SPaG Total						4
SPaG mark + composition mark						17

Overall mark for question 1	17
Overall mark for question 2	17
FINAL MARK	34

Commentary

Composition

Once again, the composition elements and the functionality of the response are strong. There is good coherence in the response and format and structure have the required elements to aid the reader. The detail and length of the response are appropriate to the task and audience. The register is suitably formal although there are some weaknesses in

Worked example – Sample paper 3 Level 1 - Pass

language choice. The candidate's knowledge of how to accurately construct complex sentences is not secure.

Spelling, punctuation and grammar

Spelling is once again weak, with many errors in relatively simple words and more complex words. Many are probably typing errors, but effective proof reading would eliminate many of them.

Punctuation is also weak, with errors including omitted capital letters, comma splices, omitted commas and incorrect use of speech marks.

Grammar is also relatively weak, with errors in verb-tense agreement and subject verb agreement. There are also some instances of omitted articles and other word types and inconsistency of tense use.

Worked example – Sample paper 3 Level 1 - Fail

Question 1

Your task: choose **one** of the following topics and write a set of instructions for someone who is brand new to the topic.

- How to load and play a video game.
- How to play a boardgame, for example, Monopoly, Chess, Draughts or Snakes and Ladders.
- How to bake a cake or make a meal.
- How to follow evacuation procedures where you study or work.
- How to learn to ride a bike.
- How to do a trick on a skateboard.
- How to play a game, for example, football or netball.
- How to use social media.
- How to build a snowman.
- How to drive a car.

(27 marks)

Suggested word count 200 – 250 words.

Put the keys in the ignishon and start the enjin and put the gear in first and then take of the hand break and push on the aselarater and drive and when you are goin fast enuff move the gear in to 2nd, you do this by push down the clutch and move the gear into second and then you peress the acselerator again untill you being going fast enuff to move it in to third gear and then repeat the clutch bit until you is in 4th and fifth and even 6th gear. if you have to stop you can us the break peddle to stop the car and then you have to stat over again wiv first gear and the acselerator. Before you stat the enjine you habve to put on you safty belt and use a indikater to go in the traffic and take a test because it is ilegal to drive with out one unless you have a liesense.

Worked example – Sample paper 3 Level 1 - Fail

Question 1	**Band 4**	**Band 3**	**Band 2**	**Band 1**	
	Consistently	**Most of the time**	**Some of the time**	**Limited**	
Communicates information, ideas and opinions clearly, coherently and accurately				✓	
Writes text of appropriate detail and length			✓		
Uses appropriate format, structure and paragraphing				✓	
Writes with accurate complex sentences and uses appropriate language				✓	
Overall band	Band 1				
Composition Marks	(12-15)	(8-11)	(4-7)	(0-3)	3

Question 1	**Consistently accurate at appropriate level 4 marks**	**Accurate most of the time 3 marks**	**Accurate some of the time 2 marks**	**Limited accuracy 1 mark**	**Insufficient evidence 0 marks**	
Spelling				1		
Punctuation				1		
Grammar		3				
SPaG Total						5
SPaG mark + composition mark						8

Commentary

Composition

There are many issues with this response. A lack of any attempt to format and structure the instructions to make them accessible to the reader, the lack of control over sentence structure, the illogical order and lack of accurate detail all affect the clarity, coherence and overall effectiveness of the instructions. Format and structure would have been greatly enhanced by separating out the information, for instance by using bullet points, numbers or line breaks. The candidate's tendency to run sentences together suggest a lack of understanding about how to best construct a set of instructions to maximise their effectiveness. Instructions tend to be best when made up of simple and compound sentences. The language used is generally acceptable in terms of tone but is slightly colloquial at times. Whilst some detail is accurate, there are many significant omissions.

Spelling, punctuation and grammar

Worked example – Sample paper 3 Level 1 - Fail

Spelling is poor, with many words misspelt, such as *off*, *without, going, enough, press, have, until, with* and almost all specialist words to do with driving, such as *engine, accelerator, ignition, indicator, safety, break* and *pedal.*

There is very little evidence of effective punctuation other than capital letters to start most sentences and the occasional full stop. There are instances of missing full stops and comma splices, and at least one instance of a lack of a capital letter to start a sentence.

Grammar is generally accurate, but there are some inaccuracies, including subject-verb errors and incorrect verb forms.

Worked example – Sample paper 3 Level 1 - Fail

Question 2

At work, you noticed several health and safety hazards and decide to write an email to your manager. The hazards included:

- a missing fire extinguisher
- a fire door propped open
- a blocked fire exit
- people smoking where they are not allowed to smoke.

Your task: write an email to your manager, explaining the following:

- why you are writing
- what you have seen
- the location of each hazard
- what the possible dangers are
- how each hazard should be corrected.

The person to send your email to is James Freeman, and his email address is jfreeman@bth.co.uk

Suggested word count 200 – 250 words.

(27 marks)

To:	
Cc:	
Subject:	

i seen a fire extingusher missing and i think this is dangerous and should of been put back by who ever taken it in the first place. this was by a door. and then I seen a fire door was open and this should of been closed becasue if there was a fire it will spread though the open door too quick. Then I seen a fire escape was blocked of so noone could of got out if there is a fire and this is not on, what is going on in this place. All of this things needs to be sorted as soon as posible or there is gonna be truble. Also I seen peopel smoking where shouldn't of been smoking and this is dangerus because others has to breth in there smoke and it is harmfull. this was outside the front door

Worked example – Sample paper 3 Level 1 - Fail

Question 2	**Band 4**	**Band 3**	**Band 2**	**Band 1**	
	Consistently	**Most of the time**	**Some of the time**	**Limited**	
Communicates information, ideas and opinions clearly, coherently and accurately			✓		
Writes text of appropriate detail and length		✓			
Uses appropriate format, structure and paragraphing				✓	
Writes with accurate complex sentences and uses appropriate language			✓		
Overall band	Band 2				
Composition Marks	(12-15)	(8-11)	(4-7)	(0-3)	7

Question 2	**Consistently accurate at appropriate level 4 marks**	**Accurate most of the time 3 marks**	**Accurate some of the time 2 marks**	**Limited accuracy 1 mark**	**Insufficient evidence 0 marks**	
Spelling			2			
Punctuation				1		
Grammar			2			
SPaG Total						5
SPaG mark + composition mark						12

Overall mark for question 1	8
Overall mark for question 2	12
FINAL MARK	20

Commentary

Composition

Once again, there has been no attempt to use appropriate format and structure: the email address of the recipient is missing, there is no subject line, no initial salutation and no closing phrase or name. The majority of the required detail is present although the location of the open fire door is not stated, and the location of the missing fire extinguisher is vague. There is a good mix of simple, compound and complex sentences, but language choices are

Worked example – Sample paper 3 Level 1 - Fail

not always appropriate, verging on being rude or unprofessional at times. Coherence also suffers through the response not containing an appropriate opening sentence and coming to such an abrupt conclusion.

Spelling, punctuation and grammar

Spelling errors are numerous and includes relatively straightforward words.

Punctuation errors include lower case when writing the first-person personal pronoun, omitted capital letters to start sentences, comma splices, omitted commas and omitted full stops.

Grammar errors include the repetition of *should of,* verb-tense errors, subject-verb errors, inconsistent use of tense and omitted words.

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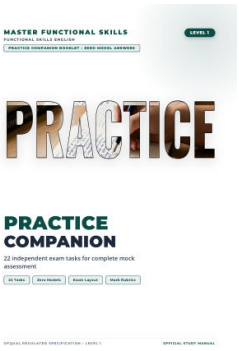


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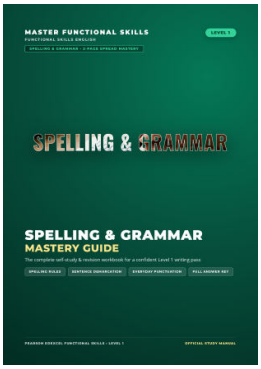


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